

How to maintain your reality when leadership makes you question your own performance — Action Checklist

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SPOT MANIPULATION TACTICS

- ☐ **Recognize all six patterns:** Learn to identify timeline distortion, blame inversion, credit theft, outcome reframing, memory denial, and emotional attribution so you can catch them in real-time conversations.
- ☐ **Watch for timeline distortion:** Check dates and sequences against your records when you notice conversations shifting about when things actually happened or were said.
- ☐ **Identify blame inversion:** Notice whether your valid concerns about problems are being reframed as evidence that you're the source of those problems instead of the person who raised them.
- ☐ **Complete the diagnostic exercise:** Write down the last five conversations where you left feeling confused or wrong, and match each one to the specific manipulation pattern used.

BUILD DOCUMENTATION HABITS

- ☐ **Create timestamped records immediately:** After any significant conversation with your manager, write down what was said while the details are still fresh and uncontaminated by later reframing attempts.
- ☐ **Build an archive under your control:** Keep a personal record of your work contributions, decisions, and achievements that only you can access and no one else can edit or delete.
- ☐ **Log specific language from performance discussions:** Capture direct quotes and exact phrases rather than summaries, so you have evidence of what was actually said when memory gets disputed.
- ☐ **Cross-reference your documentation:** Before accepting your manager's version of events, compare it against your timestamped notes to identify discrepancies and protect your ground truth.

REGULATE AND RESPOND

- ☐ **Regulate your nervous system during destabilizing moments:** Use breathing and grounding techniques when you feel off-balance so you're not responding from survival mode during critical interactions.
 - ☐ **Distinguish feedback from rewrite campaigns:** Check your documented facts against what's being presented to determine if you're receiving legitimate feedback or experiencing reality distortion.
 - ☐ **Respond from strategy, not reaction:** When pushing back on misrepresentation, use your documentation as the foundation instead of arguing from a destabilized, doubted mental state.
 - ☐ **Trust the pattern you noticed:** When your nervous system signals that something feels wrong after a conversation, treat that awareness as important data rather than dismissible oversensitivity.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.